

Three titles worth building.

Five ideas went in. Two came out. These three were scored on the same scale we used for the September wave, against what we now know actually makes a title work.

76

Energy Installer Business

The cleanest seam we have found. Launch first.

76

Convenience Business News

Ten times the audience. Highest ceiling.

69

Private Capital Business

Different money: sponsorship, not traffic.

What we are actually looking for.

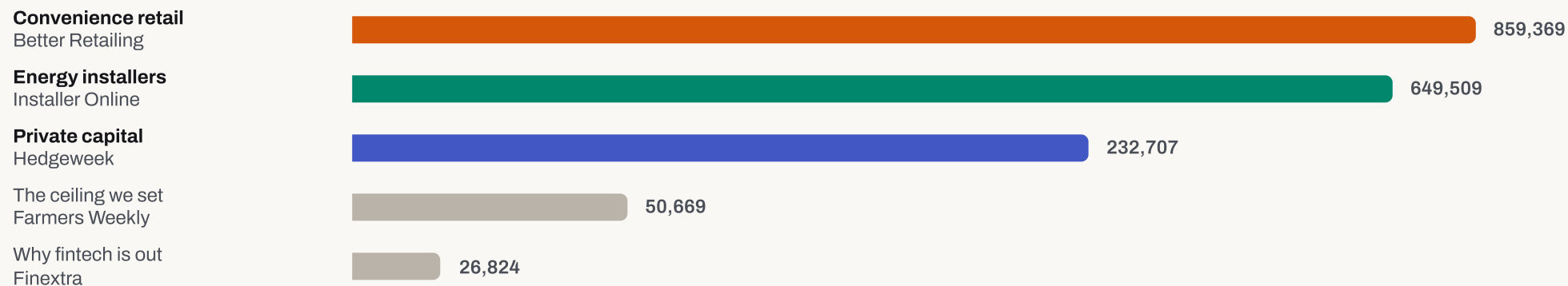
Ten titles in, the pattern is not a guess any more. Every one of these carries a weight, and the five rules below are the ones that keep proving true whatever the sector.

- 1 Win the **owner-operator tail**, never the head of the market.
- 2 Take the seam the incumbent ignores. It is almost always **the P&L**.
- 3 If software vendors hold the business searches, **they are also the ad list**.
- 4 **Openings and closures** is the strongest format in our data.
- 5 Never go head-on with an incumbent **stronger than 100,000 on Tranco**.

20	15	15	10
Advertiser depth, and proof they already spend	Incumbent weakness and an open seam	Winnable business-intent search	Money moving in the sector
10	10	10	10
Reader universe we can count	News supply that never runs dry	A CIM asset we already own	Risk, scored in reverse

Rule five, drawn out: how strong the incumbent is

longer bar = weaker incumbent = easier entry →



Tranco rank of the strongest incumbent in each sector, 24 September 2026. Log scale.

ENERGY

Energy Installer Business

76
OUT OF 100

£15bn

Warm Homes Plan, committed to 2030. Up to 5 million homes.

5,250

MCS certified contractors. A readership the scheme counts for us.

38,523

InstallerSHOW visitors in June 2026, up 20%. 900+ exhibitors.

649,509

Tranco rank of the strongest incumbent. Farmers Weekly is 50,669.

- **The trade press covers the job, not the books.** Installer Online runs product launches and prosecutions. No margin, no pricing, no lead cost, no staff cost.
- **The business searches belong to software vendors.** Payaca, Reonic, Jobber, ServiceTitan. Our competitor list is our first sales list.
- **£7,500 to £9,000 a grant**, and MCS certification is the only way to claim it. The state made our audience register itself.
- **The distress beat is already running.** Warma UK in administration, ECO4 payments stalled, two solar directors banned.

THE SEAM

The contractor who installs energy kit, read as a business. Margin, quoting, lead cost, compliance cost, and getting paid.

WATCH

Touches four of our own titles on topic. Claimed terms go into the registry before the first commission, MEPCA's by hand.

CONVENIENCE RETAIL

Convenience Business News

76
OUT OF 100

50,486

Convenience stores in mainland UK. Ten times the energy universe.

71%

Run by independents. Owner-operators, which is the reader we win.

£49.1bn

Sector sales in 2026, up 0.6% against 2.9% inflation.

859,369

Tranco rank of Better Retailing, the incumbent closest to our seam.

- **Same gap, bigger room.** Better Retailing has no section on margin, pricing, staff costs, business rates, theft or selling the store. It sells product news.
- **The trade body wrote our editorial line.** Investment down from £1bn to £900m, and the ACS names tax and business rates as the cause.
- **Three statutory dates already in the diary.** 29 Oct 2026, 1 Jan 2027, 1 Jun 2027. Every one is a commissioning slot.
- **1,200+ exhibitors at the NEC**, with the whole of FMCG behind them. The deepest advertiser pool of anything we scored.

THE SEAM

The independent store owner read as a business. Not the shelves, the shop.

WATCH

Heaviest Smart SME overlap of anything we have scored. Same relationship as Gym, so it needs an alignment sheet on day one, not month three.

FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS

Private Capital Business

69
OUT OF 100

7%

of UK GDP. 13,000 businesses backed, 2.5 million people employed.

30,000

Subscribers at the nearest rival, across two titles. Our drip reaches that in 30 weeks.

232,707

Hedgeweek's Tranco rank. Finextra, the fintech equivalent, is 26,824.

34.1%

The new effective rate on carried interest from 6 April 2026. Nobody in trade press owns it.

- **We already publish in six sectors this audience is rolling up.** Gyms, nurseries, dental, senior living, farming, barbering. That is deal intelligence no rival has.
- **The nearest rival runs our exact model.** Free, newsletter, sponsorship, one small publisher. It works, and it is beatable.
- **Professional readers, not retail.** The FCA load is a fraction of a consumer finance title, which is why this is not the fintech idea.
- **Law firms hold the compliance explainers.** Not publishers. Same shape as every seam we have taken.

THE SEAM

Who is buying UK SME operators, at what multiple, funded by whom. Plus running the firm, not running the money.

DECIDE FIRST

The money here is events and sponsorship, not display. Judged on traffic it will look like a failure while it is working.

Scored on the same eight attributes

ATTRIBUTE	● ENERGY	● CONV.	● CAPITAL
Advertiser depth /20	16	17	15
Incumbent weakness /15	11	10	10
Business-intent search /15	12	10	10
Money in sector /10	9	9	10
Reader universe /10	8	10	4
News supply /10	9	10	9
CIM asset /10	5	5	6
Risk, in reverse /10	6	5	5
Total	76	76	69

The two we are not building

52 FinTech

Finextra sits at 26,824 on Tranco and Sifted has the Financial Times behind it. Twice the strength of anything we have ever attacked, with no weak seam underneath. It is also a supplier sector, and we win operator sectors.

32 Cannabis

The search is open, the business is not. Forty clinics are the entire UK B2B market. And Mailchimp bans the category outright, so one cannabis audience would put the mailing list for all ten existing titles at risk.

For reference: Gym scored 67, Farming 66, Nurseries 56, Dental 55.

WHAT WE NEED FROM THE TEAM

- 1 Does CIM already publish** in energy, electrical or building services? And in grocery, convenience or forecourt? That row is worth 10 points and we cannot fill it.
- 2 Who owns each title?** Each needs a name against it who can list real reachable advertisers, same gate as the September five.
- 3 Sponsorship or traffic** for Private Capital Business? If it has to pay like Smart SME, we hold it.